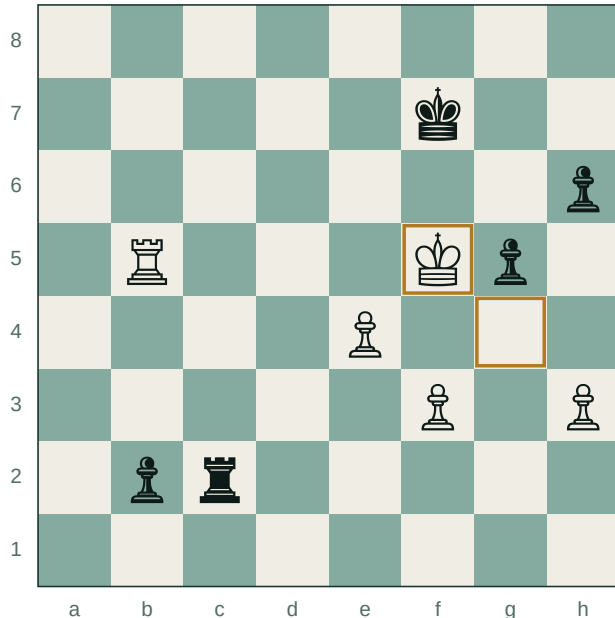


Deflection tactics: Black, move 51

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 51.Kf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

51...Rc5+ 52. Rxc5 b1=Q

51...Rc5+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From c5 it attacks king on f5 and rook on b5. Recorded reply: **52.Rxc5**.

52...b1=Q The pawn moves from b2 to b1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f5. Geometrically undefended: rook on b5. Check for tactical protection.